

# Road accidents **kill 13** The country reports the highest **1,14,590** were killed in

By Mihir Srivastava

It is, outside conflict zones, the most dangerous place on earth, a strip of lawless asphalt where an angry army of humans and a bewildering variety of vehicular traffic battle for space and the right of way. It is, quite literally, a death trap. India's killer roads account for more deaths than any other single cause, from terrorism to natural disasters. Every hour, 13 people die due to road accidents, the highest in the world. Every 10th person who dies in road accidents is an Indian. Every day, about 250 people die in road accidents, or an astonishing 1,14,590 each year. That's a horrific number and even more horrific considering that the majority of fatalities are the sole earning members of their families: 85 per cent are male and 70 per cent are in the working age group of 30 to 59 years. It is estimated that road accidents cause an

